

■ Order

`Order[ $expr_1$ ,  $expr_2$ ]` gives 1 if $expr_1$ is before $expr_2$ in canonical order, and -1 if $expr_1$ is after $expr_2$ in canonical order. It gives 0 if $expr_1$ is identical to $expr_2$.

Canonical order has several properties. Smaller numbers of a particular type come first. Symbols are ordered lexicographically according to their textual names. Strings are ordered lexicographically. Shorter expressions come first.

■ Examples: `Order[a, b]  $\longrightarrow$  1`; `Order[b, a]  $\longrightarrow$  -1`. ■ NEEDS INDEX REFERENCE ■ See also: `Equal`, `SameQ`.